

Expense Ledger — User Guide

Sep 25, 2026 · @Willy Rosales

Welcome

Expense Ledger records expenses in any of about 100 currencies and converts each one to Canadian dollars (CAD) at the rate for the day it was spent. This guide covers build v13 of the app.

With it you can:

- Add an expense with its date, amount, vendor, category, notes and a receipt photo
- See every amount converted to CAD automatically
- Mark each expense Pending, Approved or Rejected
- Search, filter and review your history
- See totals by month, year, category and vendor
- Share the same ledger across several phones, tablets and computers
- Keep working with no internet connection
- Export to Excel or CSV, or import an existing spreadsheet

The pictures in this guide are drawings of the app's screens filled with sample expenses. Your screens show your own entries, and the exact look varies slightly between iPhone, iPad and computer.

Getting started

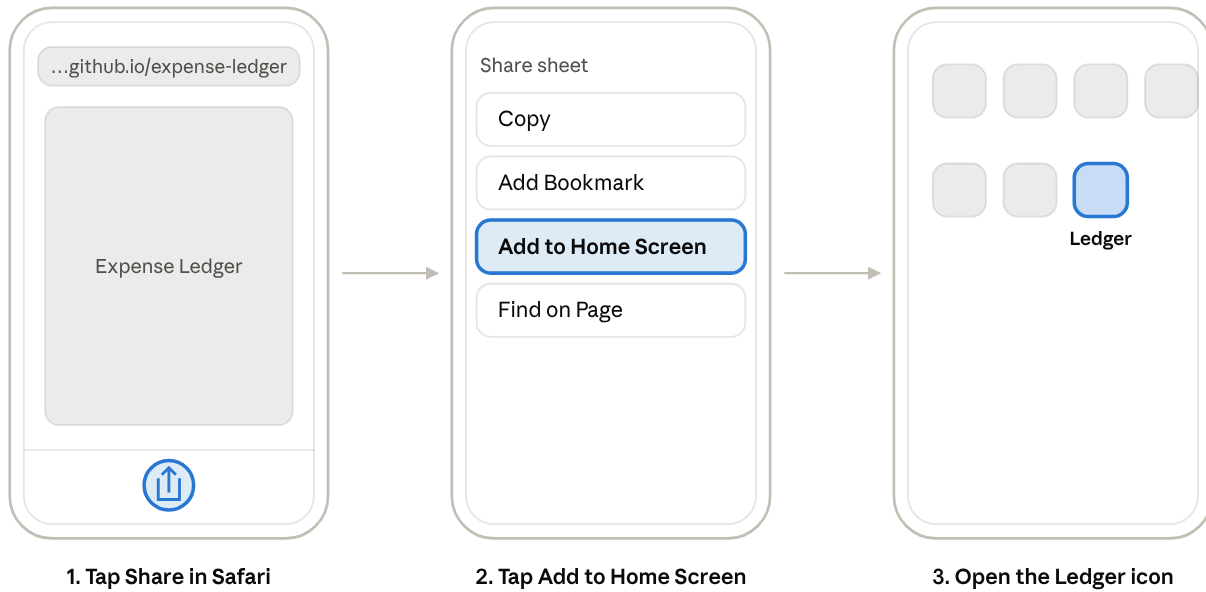
Open the app's web address in your browser. It is hosted on GitHub Pages at the address your administrator gives you, usually ending in `/expense-ledger/`.

Put it on your home screen

On an iPhone or iPad:

1. Open the address in Safari (it must be Safari, not Chrome).
2. Tap the Share button, the square with an arrow.
3. Tap Add to Home Screen, then Add.
4. Launch it from the new Ledger icon. It opens full screen, like a regular app.

Three taps put Ledger on your home screen



Adding the app to the home screen

The first launch needs an internet connection to load the app. After that it opens even when you are offline.

The three tabs

A bar along the bottom of the screen switches between the app's three pages.

Every screen has the same three parts



- 1 Page title**
The tab you are on, or Edit
- 2 Header rate**
Today's rate for your most-used currency
- 3 Tab content**
The form, the list or the summary tables
- 4 Tab bar**
Tap New, History or Summary to switch

The parts of every screen

Tab	What it is for
New	Add a new expense, or edit an existing one
History	Browse, search, edit, share and delete expenses
Summary	Totals and breakdowns, cloud sync, export and import

The rate in the corner

The top-right corner of every page shows today's exchange rate for the currency you use most, for example ₱1 = 0.02400 CAD, with the date of the rate beneath it. When you have no expenses yet, it shows the currency selected on the New form.

If the app is working offline, a grey badge above the rate says so.

Adding an expense

Open the New tab, fill in the form from top to bottom, and tap Add expense. Only the date, amount and vendor are required.

The New tab, filled in for a lunch receipt

The screenshot shows the 'New' expense entry form. At the top, it displays 'P1 = 0.02400 CAD' and 'live rate · 2026-09-25'. The form fields are as follows:

- Acting as:** A text field containing 'Willy'. Callout 1: Acting as: your name, kept on this device.
- Receipt photo:** A section with an 'Add photo' button. Callout 2: Receipt photo: optional picture.
- Date:** A date picker showing '2026-09-25'. Callout 3: Date: the day you spent the money.
- Amount:** A section with a currency dropdown set to 'PHP' and a text field containing '1250.00'. Callout 4: Currency, then the amount.
- Amount conversion:** Below the amount field, it shows '≈ C\$30.00'. Callout 5: The same amount in Canadian dollars.
- Vendor:** A dropdown menu showing 'Jollibee' with a 'Manage' link. Callout 6: Vendor: pick or add one; Manage edits the list.
- Category:** A dropdown menu showing 'Food & Dining' with a 'Manage' link. Callout 7: Category: Manage renames, adds or deletes.
- Submitted by:** A text field containing 'Willy'. Callout 8: Submitted by: filled in from Acting as.
- Comments:** A text field containing 'Team lunch'. Callout 9: Comments: optional notes.
- Add expense:** A large blue button at the bottom. Callout 10: Saves the expense and clears the form.

At the bottom of the form, there are three tabs: 'New' (selected), 'History', and 'Summary'.

The New tab with a sample lunch expense

- 1. Acting as** — type your name once. The app remembers it on this device and uses it to fill in Submitted by. It is also recorded as the reviewer when you approve or reject an expense.
- 2. Receipt photo** — tap Add photo to take a picture or pick one from your library. The app shrinks it to save space. Tap the small preview to see it full size, or Remove to take it off.
- 3. Date** — today's date is filled in. Change it to the day you actually spent the money, because that date decides the exchange rate.

4. **Amount** — pick the currency on the left (PHP is the default) and type the amount on the right. A line underneath shows the CAD equivalent as you type.
5. **Vendor** — choose from the list of vendors you have used before, or choose + Add new vendor... at the bottom, type the name and tap Add.
6. **Category** — choose one, such as Food & Dining or Transportation.
7. **Submitted by** — filled in from Acting as. You can change it for this one expense.
8. **Comments** — optional notes.
9. Tap **Add expense**. The button reads Converting... while the rate is fetched, then a short message confirms it was saved and the form clears for the next one.

Every new expense starts as Pending.

If something is missing

A red message appears above the button if the date is blank, the vendor is blank, or the amount is zero or less. Fix it and tap Add expense again.

If a photo is too large even after shrinking, the app asks for a closer, clearer shot.

Editing an expense

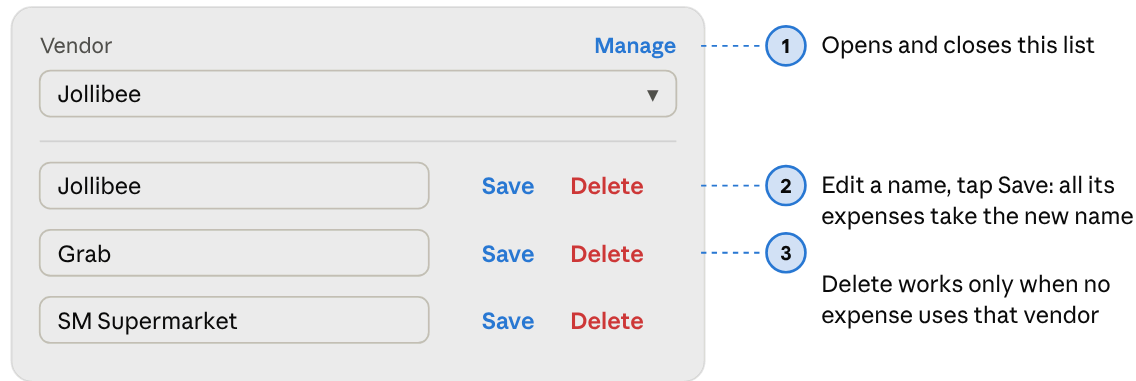
Tap Edit on any expense in History. The New tab opens with the page title Edit and the expense filled in. Change what you need and tap Save changes, and you return to History. Tap Cancel at the top to leave without saving.

Saving an edit looks up the exchange rate again for the date shown, so changing the date or currency updates the CAD amount.

Managing vendors and categories

Tap Manage beside the Vendor or Category label on the New tab to open an edit list under it. Tap Manage again to close it.

Tap Manage to edit the vendor list in place



Vendor manager open on the New tab

Vendors

- **Rename** — change the name in the box and tap Save. Every expense with the old name is updated to the new one.
- **Delete** — tap Delete. A vendor that is still used by any expense cannot be deleted; the app tells you how many expenses use it. Rename it instead, or delete those expenses first.
- **Add** — use + Add new vendor... in the Vendor list. A vendor typed on a new expense is also added automatically.

Categories

The app starts with eight categories: Food & Dining, Transportation, Accommodation, Utilities, Office & Supplies, Health & Wellness, Entertainment and Other.

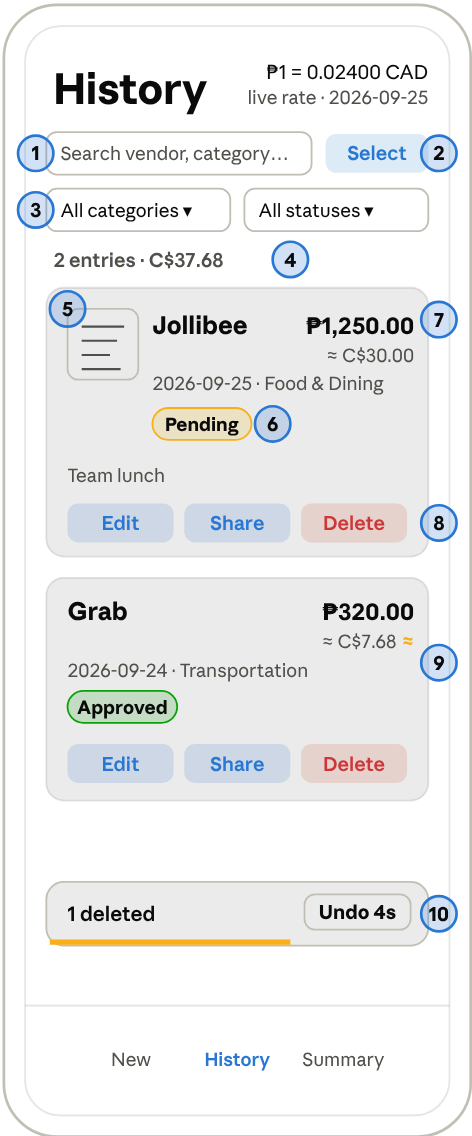
- **Rename** — change the name and tap Save. Every expense in that category moves to the new name.
- **Delete** — tap Delete. Its expenses move to another category, which the app names in its confirmation. At least one category must remain.
- **Add** — type a name in the New category box at the bottom of the list and tap Add.

The lists always include every vendor and category that appears on an expense, so a name never disappears while an expense still uses it.

The History tab

History lists every expense as a card, newest first, with a running count and CAD total above the list.

The History tab and the parts of an expense card



- 1 Search vendor, category, notes or name
- 2 Select: tick several expenses to delete
- 3 Filter by category or by status
- 4 How many are shown, and their C\$ total
- 5 Receipt photo: tap to see it full size
- 6 Status: tap to change it
- 7 Amount as spent, and in C\$ below it
- 8 Edit, share or delete this expense
- 9 Amber ≈: the exact rate was not available
- 10 Undo bar: 6 seconds to take back a delete

The History tab · sample entries

Reading an expense card

- **Left:** the receipt thumbnail, if there is one. Tap it to see the photo full size; tap anywhere to close.

- **Middle:** the vendor in large type, then the date, category and who submitted it, then the status button.
- **Right:** the amount in its own currency, and beneath it the CAD equivalent. An $\approx$ mark after the CAD amount means the exact rate was not available (see Currency conversion below).
- **Bottom:** any comments, then the Edit, Share and Delete buttons.

Finding expenses

- **Search** — the search box matches vendor, category, comments and the Submitted by name.
- **Category filter** — choose one category, or All categories.
- **Status filter** — choose Pending, Approved or Rejected, or All statuses.

The count and total above the list always reflect what the filters are showing.

Approving and rejecting

Tap the coloured status button on a card to move it to the next status: Pending (amber) → Approved (green) → Rejected (red) → back to Pending. Your Acting as name is recorded as the reviewer.

Status loop

Sharing one expense

Tap Share to send a short text summary of that expense (vendor, date, category, both amounts, submitter and comments) through Messages, Mail, WhatsApp or any other app. If your device has no share sheet, the text is copied to the clipboard instead.

Deleting and undoing

Tap Delete on a card. A dark bar appears at the bottom with an Undo button and a 6-second countdown. Tap Undo before it runs out to bring the expense back; after that the delete is permanent.

Deleting several at once

1. Tap Select beside the search box. A tick box appears on every card.

- 2. Tick the expenses you want, or tap All to tick everything currently showing (tap None to clear).
- 3. Tap Delete in the bar that shows how many are selected. The same 6-second Undo applies.
- 4. Tap Done to leave select mode.

The Summary tab

Summary totals your expenses four ways, all in CAD, newest period first. The search, category and status filters you set on History also apply here, so the totals match what History is showing.

The Summary tab · sample figures

Table	Columns	Tap a row to see
By month	Period, number of expenses, Original total, CAD total	That month split by category and by vendor
By year	Period, number, Original, CAD	—
By category	Category, CAD total	That category split by month and by vendor
By vendor	Vendor, CAD total	That vendor split by month and by category

The Original column shows a total in the original currency only when every expense in that period used the same currency. When currencies are mixed it reads "mixed", because adding pesos to dollars would give a meaningless number.

Drilling down to the expenses

Tap a month, category or vendor row to open its breakdown; tap again to close it. Each breakdown has a View these in History button. It switches to History showing only those expenses, with a blue chip at the top such as "Showing: Food & Dining". Tap the chip to clear it and see everything again.

The bottom of the Summary tab also holds the Cloud sync and Export & import panels, covered below, and the build number (currently v13).

Currency conversion

Each expense is converted to CAD at the rate for its own date, and that rate is saved with the expense. Later rate changes never alter an expense you have already saved; only editing it does.

Converting an amount

Rates come from free public exchange-rate services. When the exact date is not available, the app falls back in this order so that saving is never blocked:

What the app used	When	The confirmation message says
The exact date's rate	Normally	Expense added
The closest date within 10 days	No rate published that day, such as a weekend or holiday	Used the closest available rate, with its date
The last rate it saved for that currency	The rate service could not be reached	Exchange service unavailable, used last known rate, with its date
A 1-to-1 placeholder	No rate has ever been found for that currency	Saved with a 1:1 placeholder; edit later to fix

Any expense that did not get the exact rate shows an ≈ mark after its CAD amount in History. On a computer, hover over the mark to see which rate was used.

To fix a placeholder or fallback rate, open the expense with Edit and tap Save changes while you are online. The app looks the rate up again.

CAD amounts are always written C\$ so they cannot be confused with US\$ or other dollars.

Cloud sync and working offline

When cloud sync is set up, every device that opens the app sees and edits the same ledger, and changes appear on the others within seconds. The Cloud sync panel on the Summary tab shows the current state.

Cloud sync panel on the Summary tab

Panel says	Badge	What it means
Online	syncing on	Everything saves to the shared cloud ledger
Syncing...	syncing	Expenses added offline are being uploaded
No connection	waiting	This device has lost its signal; expenses are saved on the device and upload by themselves when the signal returns
Offline mode	paused	You switched to Work offline; expenses save on this device only
This device only	local only	Cloud sync has not been set up; data lives only in this browser

Working offline on purpose

Tap Work offline to stop using the cloud, for example on a weak or costly connection. A grey badge in the page header reminds you. When you are ready, tap Go back online & sync. Everything added in the meantime uploads, and any expense already in the cloud with the same date, vendor, currency and amount is skipped so nothing is doubled.

Losing the signal

You do not need to do anything. Keep adding expenses; the header shows "No connection · saved on this device" and the app uploads them once the signal is back. Exchange rates need the internet, so while offline the app uses the last rate it knows for that currency.

Good to know

- Your Acting as name and default Submitted by name stay on each device and are never shared.
- Anyone who has the app's address can see and change the shared ledger. Share the address only with people you trust.
- In This device only mode, clearing your browser's website data erases the ledger. Export a copy regularly (see below).

Export and import

Both live in the Export & import panel near the bottom of the Summary tab.

Exporting

Tap Export. A panel shows how many expenses will go out and their CAD total, with three choices:

Export & import panel and the Export menu

- **Excel (.xlsx)** — a workbook with four sheets: Expenses, Monthly Summary (with a grand total), By Category and By Vendor.
- **CSV (.csv)** — a plain spreadsheet file of the expenses.
- **Send via Mail, Messages, WhatsApp...** — opens your device's share sheet with the CSV file attached. If there is no share sheet, a new email opens with the data in its body.

Files are named with today's date, for example expenses-2026-09-25.xlsx. On an iPhone or iPad the share sheet opens so you can save the file to Files or send it anywhere.

Export includes only the expenses your History search and filters are showing. Clear them first to export everything. Receipt photos are not included.

Each exported row has: Date, Vendor, Category, Submitted By, Status, Amount (Original), Currency, Rate (to CAD), Amount (CAD) and Comments.

Importing

Tap Import file and choose a CSV or Excel file. The app reads the first sheet and matches columns by name, in any order and in any capitals:

Column	Required	If missing
Date	Yes	Row skipped
Vendor (or Payee, Merchant)	Yes	Row skipped
Amount (or Amount (Original), Original Amount)	Yes, above zero	Row skipped
Currency	No	PHP
Category	No	Other
Submitted By	No	Left blank
Status	No	Pending
Comments (or Notes)	No	Left blank

Each imported row is converted to CAD at the rate for its own date. A green note then reports how many rows were added, how many were skipped as duplicates, and how many had missing or invalid data. Tap Dismiss to hide it.

A row that matches an existing expense on date, vendor, currency and amount is skipped, so re-importing the same file is safe. A file exported from this app can be imported straight back.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
"Couldn't load the app's libraries"	The first load needs a steady connection. Move to a better signal and tap Reload.
"The app couldn't start" with an error message	Copy the message and send it to whoever maintains the app.
An expense shows an ≈ mark	The exact rate wasn't available. Edit the expense and tap Save changes while online to look it up again.

Problem	What to do
The CAD amount equals the original amount	A 1:1 placeholder was used. Edit and save it while online.
Entries from another device don't appear	Check both devices show Online in the Cloud sync panel. Close the app fully and reopen it.
Summary or History looks incomplete	A search, filter or blue "Showing" chip is limiting the list. Clear them on the History tab.
The Export button is greyed out	Nothing matches the current filters. Clear the search and filters.
A vendor won't delete	It is still used by an expense. Rename it, or delete those expenses first.
An import reports rows with invalid data	Those rows lack a date, vendor or positive amount. Fix them in the spreadsheet and import again; rows already added will be skipped.
Add to Home Screen is missing	On iPhone and iPad, use Safari.
I deleted something by mistake	Tap Undo within 6 seconds. After that it cannot be recovered in the app, but you can re-import it from an earlier export.
The app looks out of date after an update	Swipe the app away in the app switcher and open it again.

Quick reference

To...	Go to	Tap
Add an expense	New	Fill in the form, then Add expense
Add a receipt photo	New	Add photo
Add a vendor	New	Vendor list → + Add new vendor...
Rename or delete a vendor or category	New	Manage beside its label

To...	Go to	Tap
Edit an expense	History	Edit on its card
Approve or reject	History	The status button on its card, until it shows the one you want
Share one expense	History	Share on its card
Delete one expense	History	Delete on its card (Undo within 6 seconds)
Delete several	History	Select, tick them, Delete
See monthly or yearly totals	Summary	By month / By year
See what's in a month, category or vendor	Summary	Its row, then View these in History
Work without the internet	Summary	Work offline
Upload offline entries	Summary	Go back online & sync
Export to Excel or CSV	Summary	Export
Import a spreadsheet	Summary	Import file